

Elijah Samuels

415-724-4341 | elijahsamuels@gmail.com

[GitHub](#) | [GitLab](#) | [Website](#) | [LinkedIn](#)

FULLSTACK SOFTWARE ENGINEER

Full Stack Software Engineer with a background in building high stakes applications within fintech and telecommunications. Proven track record of architecting scalable marketing engines and drastically reducing infrastructure overhead, including a 93% reduction in annual cloud expenditure. I combine technical rigor in the JavaScript ecosystem with a product-first mindset to build intuitive, user-centric solutions. Passionate about AI-native development and leading collaborative teams that prioritize shipping, learning, and continuous system improvement.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: JavaScript (ES6+), TypeScript, Python, Ruby, HTML5/CSS3.

Frameworks & Libraries: Node.js, Express, React, Redux, Ruby on Rails (RoR), MUI.

Infrastructure & Cloud: AWS (Cloud Practitioner), Terraform, Linux, GitHub, GitLab.

Security & Data: Open Policy Agent (OPA/Styra), ABAC, MySQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB

Architecture & Testing: REST, SOAP, XML, UML (Sequence Diagrams), Jest, Playwright, Cypress, Splunk.

AWARDS & ACHIEVEMENTS

Phishing Stories Competition (Social Engineering Village) - The Wizard Award [DEFCON 34 \(2026\)](#), [DEFCON 33 \(2025\)](#)

- Awarded for crafting the most technical email phishing simulation.
- Applied offensive security knowledge to inform more robust defensive software development practices.

Cloud Practitioner Certification

AWS (2025)

- [82bbd038-e9d4-4d08-bed5-b1b6cd70b0da](#)

EXPERIENCE

CoBank

Denver, CO

Fullstack Software Engineer

November 2024 - Current

- Implemented Policy-as-Code (PaC) by developing and validating OPA policies with Styra; established Attribute-Based Access Control (ABAC) and JWT-based security to harden API endpoints.
- Established system observability by building comprehensive Splunk dashboards and automated alerting for API logging and metrics, reducing debugging latency and improving production stability.
- Hardened infrastructure security by automating AWS RDS authentication and environment variable management using AWS secrets manager.
- Streamlined data governance by managing complex database migrations with Flyway, ensuring reliable, version-controlled, and repeatable schema changes across environments.
- Optimized CI/CD maturity by integrating automated unit and integration testing into GitHub pipelines, increasing deployment confidence and code quality.
- Engineered financial reconciliation engines using Python-based scheduled processes (CRON) to maintain data integrity as transaction statuses update.

Charter Communications (Spectrum)

Denver, CO

Software Engineer III

August 2022 - November 2024

- Engineered high-impact cost-saving measures, reducing annual AWS expenditure from ~\$200k to ~\$14k (93% reduction) by optimizing AuroraDB query performance and strategically right-sizing database instances.
- Architected and spearheaded the development of a high-scale SMS marketing engine, significantly expanding national customer engagement and outreach capabilities.
- Defined technical standards by developing robust API contracts and endpoints in Node/Express, utilizing sequence diagrams (UML) and comprehensive documentation to streamline cross-team integrations.
- Pioneered an A/B testing & experimentation framework, empowering product owners with data-driven insights that directly influenced marketing strategy and UI/UX enhancements.
- Drove engineering excellence by integrating automated accessibility (a11y) reporting, E2E testing, and integration suites into GitLab CI/CD pipelines, ensuring high-quality production releases.
- Facilitated agile leadership, managing end-to-end production deployments, leading ceremonies, and presenting technical roadmaps to executive stakeholders.
- Cultivated team growth through active pair programming and mentorship of junior developers, fostering a culture of technical rigor and collaborative problem-solving.

PureSoul Presents

Developer

Remote
September 2021 - May 2022

- Custom CRM built with React/Redux, RoR & Postgres database via AWS
- Organized 200+ musicians throughout USA

University of Colorado, Denver

Adjunct Faculty

Denver, CO
August 2014 - May 2018

Courses taught:

- Music Appreciation
- Ear Training Sight Singing 1, 2 & 3
- History and Literature of Music 1
- Applied Clarinet, Flute, Saxophone

Diamond Empire Band/Historical Events Company

Manager

Midwestern USA
2013 - 2024

- Generated over \$1.5M in gross revenue (2019) through coordinating over 300 events
- Organized 1,000+ musicians throughout the mid-western region (NM, UT, CO, KS, MO, NE, AR)

Apple

Content Manager

Cupertino, CA
November 2007 - April 2009

- Increased team efficiency and accuracy by incorporating AppleScript macros to automate data entry
- Software and hardware technician for 30+ person team

EDUCATION**Flatiron School**

Full Stack Software Engineer

Denver, CO
April 2021**University of Denver**

Master of Music (Jazz Composition & Arranging)

Denver, CO
May 2013**San Francisco State University**

Bachelor of Music (Music Education)

San Francisco, CA
May 2007